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HTML semantic elements 30m

Semantic elements were introduced in HTML5. A semantic element's name describes the use or meaning of that element. Take, for example, the semantic element `<nav>`. This element is used for navigation content while `<header>` is used to define the header of a document or section. The tag `<section>` defines a section in the HTML page, a tag we can use to describe some of the sections portrayed in a wireframe.

The image below demonstrates how semantic HTML elements might appear on the screen and what each element is used for. Go to [semantic HTML elements](#) (Web.dev, n.d.) to learn more about semantic elements.

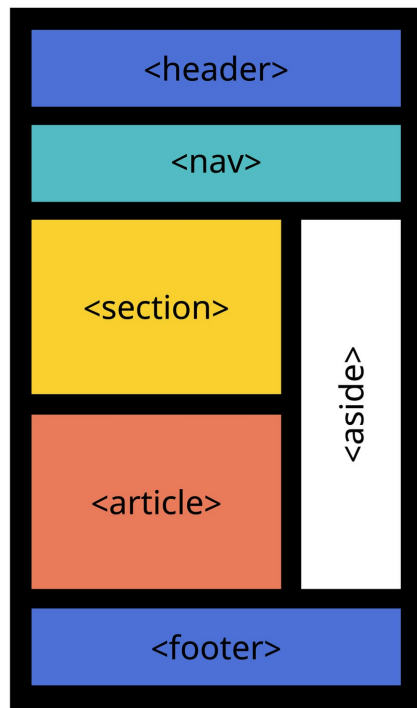
Although the semantic elements do not contribute towards the page structure, they are important for accessibility, page 'crawlers' or 'scrapers' and screen readers. They provide some meaning to the various sections of the HTML page. For example, `<div>` does not describe a section, but `<header>` and `<footer>` do.



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Semantic HTML



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Common HTML semantic element tags are listed below.

Tag	Description
<article>	Defines independent self-contained content, such as a blog post
<aside>	Specifies some content that is indirectly related to the content it is placed in, such as a sidebar
<details>	Defines additional details that the user can display and hide on demand. This tag uses a <summary> tag to define a heading for the details.

Skip to main content

<figure>	Defines self-contained content, such as a photo, a diagram or an illustration
<figcaption>	Specifies a caption for a photo marked up using a <figure> tag
<footer>	Identifies the footer section of a document. It can have information, such as copyright information, contact information and sitemap.
<header>	Defines introductory content or navigational links and can include heading elements, author names and other elements
<main>	Defines the main content of a <body> and should be unique to the document
<mark>	Specifies a part which should be highlighted
<nav>	Defines a set of internal or external navigational links, such as menus
<section>	Specifies a part of a document, such as a chapter or contact information
<time>	Defines a date/time

Dig deeper

W3Schools provides a good summary of semantic elements, as well as providing examples of common semantic elements. Refer to [HTML Semantic Elements](#) (W3Schools, n.d.) if you want to learn more about semantic elements.



☒ HTML Tags and Descriptions 2

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Drag each HTML tag from the left column to the correct description in the right column

<code><main></code>	Defines the main content of a <code><body></code> and should be unique to the document ✓
<code><nav></code>	Defines a set of internal or external navigational links, such as menus ✓
<code><time></code>	Defines a date/time ✓
<code><mark></code>	Specifies a part which should be highlighted ✓
<code><section></code>	Specifies a part of a document, such as a chapter or contact information. ✓
<code><header></code>	Defines introductory content or navigational links and can include heading elements, author names and other elements ✓

Here are the answers for the drag-and-drop activity, matching each HTML tag to its description:

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Tag	Description
<header>	Defines introductory content or navigational links and can include heading elements, author names and other elements
<main>	Defines the main content of a <body> and should be unique to the document
<mark>	Specifies a part which should be highlighted
<nav>	Defines a set of internal or external navigational links, such as menus
<section>	Specifies a part of a document, such as a chapter or contact information
<time>	Defines a date/time

Previous attempts ▼



☒ HTML Tags and Descriptions 1

Non-Assessed

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Drag each HTML tag from the left column to the correct description in the right column

<code><figure></code>	Defines self-contained content, such as a photo, a diagram or an illustration ✓
<code><footer></code>	Identifies the footer section of a document. It can have information, such as copyright information, contact information and sitemap. ✓
<code><details></code>	Defines additional details that the user can display and hide on demand. This tag uses a <code><summary></code> tag to define a heading for the details. ✓
<code><article></code>	Defines independent self-contained content, such as a blog post ✓
<code><aside></code>	Specifies some content that is indirectly related to the content it is placed in, such as a sidebar ✓
<code><figcaption></code>	Specifies a caption for a photo marked up using a <code><figure></code> tag ✓

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Thoughts on this page?

